2

The Discovery of Coloniality and the Birth of Decoloniality



Destruction of the Indies, 1552

Depiction of Christopher Columbus' soldiers chopping the hands off Arawak Indians who failed to meet the mining quota in Bartolomé de Las Casas' *Brevisima relación de la destrucción de las Indias*. The print was made by two Flemish artists (who did not actually witness these atrocities)—Joos van Winghe was the designer and Theodor de Bry, the engraver.

At the turn of the twentieth century, after close to five centuries of European colonialism, thanks to the ebb and flow of history, the native